Image 6.1: Pakistan Occupied Jammu and Kashmir
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

The British Hand

Throughout 1948 the fighting continued unabated. Gen. Rob Lockhart, the Indian Commander-in-Chief, was pro-Pakistan in his outlook, as was[10] his successor, Gen. Bucher. All through 1948, Bucher would moderate military decisions not only because of possible political repercussions, but also because he believed that the Kashmir conflict potentially brought communism to the doorstep of the subcontinent.[11] He also empathised with Pakistan's vital need for Kashmir in terms of defence, water supplies and the need to control the NWFP.

These two generals were strongly supported by the West Punjab Governor, Sir Robert Francis Mudie. Mudie attended school with Sir George Cunningham and Gen. Rob Lockhart and after they reunited in India, they were all a part of the British deep state that thought it necessary for Pakistan to retain a post-Partition presence in the part of India that contained Kashmir and the NWFP.[12] Mudie anticipated three threats to Pakistan's existence,[13] namely the Afghan-Russia threat, the India-Abdul Ghaffar Khan threat and the conflict in Kashmir. He was of the view that Pakistan was the only barrier to the spread of communism in the subcontinent. Another famous officer of the Pakistan Army, Maj. Gen. W. J. Cawthorn, founder of Pakistan's ISI very lucidly voiced all the British strategic fears arising from the Kashmir dispute. His speech in London's Chatham House in 1948 has him arguing that Pakistan could not afford to have a hostile India by the western borders of Jammu and Kashmir. It would bring the Indian Army within 30 miles of the Pakistan Army Headquarters in Rawalpindi, right behind its vital north-south communication line. It would give India control over the waters of Chenab, Jhelum and Indus rivers, and would put India in direct contact with Afghanistan, Chitral and Swat. There was already speculation that the